Main question: ***Evaluate the effectiveness of operations management strategies in achieving performance objectives.***

- This task was well done by many students with good use of case study/ies showing an effort had been made to prepare and remember data about a range of businesses.

- All students made reference to case study/ies and most were able to use relevant case studies.

- Better responses showed a clear understanding of the syllabus with clear explanation of the appropriate terms that were appropriate in answering the question (eg operations management strategies and performance objectives) and then used their case study to support their response.

- To present a "logical, cohesive and sustained response" it was necessary to address three different operations management strategies.

- The directive verb of the question was "evaluate" – this required you to make a judgement based on criteria (in this case the performance objectives) and back up your judgement with evidence.

- To obtain an A range mark you needed to include relevant data as evidence.

- The better structured essays used one paragraph for each operations management strategy.

- A number of students used business goals (eg profit, market share etc) as the criteria instead of performance objectives. While this information can be included you must first use the performance objectives and then make the link to business goals.

- A number of students included information on influences in operations. This information was not necessary to answer the question. It can be included as long as the correct linkages to the strategies are made however you should be mindful of the following:

  - time constraints apply and you don't want to include this information at the expense of more relevant information relating to the question; and

  - it could make your response appear to be rote learned rather than a direct answer of the question .

Moving forward, it is important to use this feedback and your individual feedback, read the exemplars carefully and consider whether your case study/ies were appropriate for this type of question.

Alternate question: ***Evaluate the effectiveness of operations management strategies in sustaining a competitive advantage.***

- this question required you to understand the competitors for your chosen case studies and explain the operations management strategies implemented by your case studies to gain a competitive advantage.

- furthermore the question is "…**sustaining** a competitive advantage…." ; to move into the A range you needed to address how the case studies were able to (or not able to) achieve **sustained** competitive advantage.

- To obtain an A range mark you needed to include relevant data as evidence.